
roles and tasks

What different roles and tasks exist in a transdisciplinary team? And what about you: how exactly can you participate and contribute to the project? This torch discusses three basic tasks: acting, deciding and guiding - tasks that of course overlap as well.

Act

The basic task of ‘acting’ refers to your own direct contributions, regardless of your background with the project. Do not hesitate to take responsibility, step out of your own beaten path and encourage others to do the same.

Another typical attitude for transdisciplinary working is an inquisitive mindset. Since nothing is clear at the beginning of a transdisciplinary project, you must be willing to create and explore new knowledge.

Decision-making

In the project, you make decisions together with different stakeholders, not just by those with the most experience or the loudest voice. In the safe environment, everyone should be heard.

Guide

Although you want to work together as equally as possible, sometimes it is necessary for one individual to oversee the process, encourage breakthroughs and balance the needs of the group with the practical framework. You can call these people the 'guides'.

Guides have 2 roles in transdisciplinary projects. First, they often take the initiative to set up and co-design a transdisciplinary project. Later, they promote progress as coaches. This applies especially - but not exclusively! - to the teaching environment. Here, teachers or other students can guide the learning process of participating students.

Regardless of the role you take on during the project, you also participate from a certain stakeholder position. Your previous experiences will almost certainly influence how you experience a transdisciplinary process.